

# WOODLAND DREAMS LACE COLLAR

## LME BABY COLLECTION - WOODLAND DREAMS

A loose, airy lace collar that drapes over the shoulders and fastens at the back with one small wooden button, not knitted onto the body itself. The collar is cast on along the neck edge, flares gently outward and finishes with a simple eyelet pattern and a picot edge for the delicate, lacy look. Seven sizes, from 0-1 to 18-24 months, sized to fit the neck opening of the Woodland Dreams basisbody. The lace collar is the first accessory piece in the "Woodland Dreams" collection.

**By Renate Dahl**

Little Montessori Explorers

[lmexplorers.com](http://lmexplorers.com)



*TIP: Read through the whole pattern and the size chart on page 4 before you start, and knit a 15 x 15 cm gauge swatch to check your tension, before casting on the collar itself.*

## ABOUT THE WOODLAND DREAMS LACE COLLAR

### THE FIRST ACCESSORY PIECE

The lace collar is the first of six accessory pieces in LME Woodland Dreams. It is not knitted onto the basisbody, but a separate, standalone piece that drapes over the shoulders and fastens at the back, just like a loose collar should. This means the same body can be styled in several ways, without knitting a whole new garment for every outfit.

### STYLE

Scandinavian and timeless, with a light, delicate eyelet pattern along the outer edge, not a heavy allover lace repeat. The shape is calm and rounded, and the collar should feel airy and delicate against the skin, without becoming a decoration that steals attention from the body itself.

### FASTENS AT THE BACK

**The collar is cast on slightly narrower than the full neck circumference, leaving an opening at the back. This opening closes with one small wooden button and a crocheted chain loop, the same principle as the buttonhole loops on the basisbody. This makes the collar quick to put on and take off, without pulling anything over the baby's head.**

## MATERIALS

### YARN

Sandnes Garn Alpaka (100% alpaca), the same yarn and gauge as the basisbody. The collar is an accessory, so choose one of the collection's accessory colours for it, in contrast to the body's neutral colours: sage, dusty rose, butter yellow, soft blue, olive or terracotta.

### YARN REQUIREMENTS

| Size      | Yarn amount |
|-----------|-------------|
| 0-1 mnd   | 15-20 g     |
| 1-3 mnd   | 16-21 g     |
| 3-6 mnd   | 18-23 g     |
| 6-9 mnd   | 19-24 g     |
| 9-12 mnd  | 20-25 g     |
| 12-18 mnd | 22-27 g     |
| 18-24 mnd | 23-28 g     |

Approximate figures, depending a little on gauge. The collar uses very little yarn, a leftover from the body is often enough if you choose the same colour, or buy one skein in the contrast colour.

### NEEDLES AND NOTIONS

**Circular needle 4 mm, 40 cm (worked back and forth, not in the round, since the collar is flat). One small, round wooden button. A 3 mm crochet hook for the chain loop at the back. A tapestry needle for weaving in ends and sewing on the button. Stitch markers are optional, but can make it easier to keep track of the evenly spaced increases in part 2.**

## SIZE CHART

Finished measurements, measured lying flat. Choose size to match the neck opening of the basisbody you are knitting the collar for.

| Size      | Neck opening (basisbody) | Outer edge, lace border | Collar depth |
|-----------|--------------------------|-------------------------|--------------|
| 0-1 mnd   | 21 cm                    | 22.7 cm                 | 4.7 cm       |
| 1-3 mnd   | 22 cm                    | 23.6 cm                 | 4.7 cm       |
| 3-6 mnd   | 23 cm                    | 26.4 cm                 | 4.7 cm       |
| 6-9 mnd   | 24 cm                    | 27.3 cm                 | 4.7 cm       |
| 9-12 mnd  | 25 cm                    | 28.2 cm                 | 4.7 cm       |
| 12-18 mnd | 26 cm                    | 30.0 cm                 | 4.7 cm       |
| 18-24 mnd | 27 cm                    | 30.9 cm                 | 4.7 cm       |

The collar is cast on 2.5 cm narrower than the neck opening in the table, this difference becomes the opening at the back that closes with a button and loop, see part 4.

## GAUGE AND DIFFICULTY LEVEL

### GAUGE

22 stitches and 30 rows in stockinette stitch = 10 x 10 cm, on 4 mm needles, the same gauge as the basisbody. This gauge is used in every calculation in the pattern. Always knit a swatch first: cast on 26 stitches, work stockinette stitch for approx. 12 cm, bind off and block lightly. If your gauge does not match, change to a smaller or larger needle until it does, not just to match the yarn.

### DIFFICULTY LEVEL

**Easy to medium.** You should be comfortable with stockinette stitch, garter stitch, a simple increase (M1) and a simple decrease (k2tog), as well as yarn overs and a picot bind-off. The collar is small, so even the new techniques are over quickly. You should also be able to crochet a simple chain for the loop at the back.

## ABBREVIATIONS

Norwegian knitting terms with the English terms alongside. The collar is worked flat, so "row" is used, not "round", throughout the pattern.

| Norwegian       | English      | Meaning                                                             |
|-----------------|--------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------|
| r               | K            | rett                                                                |
| vr              | P            | vrang                                                               |
| m               | st(s)        | maske(r)                                                            |
| rad             | row          | rad (kragen strikkes flatt)                                         |
| øk1 / M1        | M1           | øk 1 maske (ta opp tråden mellom to masker, strikk vridd rett)      |
| o               | yo           | omslag (kaster tråden rundt pinnen, gir et hull og en ekstra maske) |
| r2sm            | k2tog        | strikk 2 rett sammen (feller 1 maske)                               |
| rillestrikk     | garter st    | strikk rett på alle rader, begge sider                              |
| fell av         | BO           | fell av / bind off                                                  |
| picot-avfelling | picot BO     | dekorativ avfelling med små tagger                                  |
| legg opp        | CO           | legg opp masker                                                     |
| kjedemasker     | chain sts    | luftmasker i hekling                                                |
| heklenål        | crochet hook | heklenål                                                            |
| maskemarkør     | st marker    | maskemarkør                                                         |

### TIPS

- Count your stitches after the increase row in part 2, and again after the last eyelet row in part 3, before you start the picot bind-off. It is far easier to fix a mistake there than partway through the bind-off.
- Consider placing a stitch marker at each M1 increase in part 2, it makes it easier to see that the increases really are evenly spaced.
- Practise the M1 increase and the picot bind-off on your swatch first, if you have not knitted them before. Both techniques are simple, but easier once your fingers have tried them once.

## HOW THE COLLAR IS CONSTRUCTED

The collar is knitted flat, back and forth, in one piece. Four simple parts, in this order:

### 1. Neck edge

Cast on along the neck edge, minus the back opening, work a short garter stitch band for structure.

### 2. Flare increase

Increase evenly spaced over one row, so the collar flares outward from the neck edge.

### 3. Lace border

Work a few rows of stockinette, then a simple 2-row eyelet pattern, finish with a picot bind-off.

### 4. Back closure

Crochet a chain loop at one back edge, sew a wooden button onto the other.

## PART 1: THE NECK EDGE

Cast on along the neck edge, flat, back and forth (not in the round). The cast-on stitch count is calculated from the neck opening in the size chart, minus the back opening, multiplied by the gauge. Then work a short garter stitch band for structure, before the flare increase in part 2.

| Size      | Neck opening | Back gap | Cast-on (sts) | Rows of garter st |
|-----------|--------------|----------|---------------|-------------------|
| 0-1 mnd   | 21 cm        | 2.5 cm   | 40            | 4                 |
| 1-3 mnd   | 22 cm        | 2.5 cm   | 42            | 4                 |
| 3-6 mnd   | 23 cm        | 2.5 cm   | 46            | 4                 |
| 6-9 mnd   | 24 cm        | 2.5 cm   | 48            | 4                 |
| 9-12 mnd  | 25 cm        | 2.5 cm   | 50            | 4                 |
| 12-18 mnd | 26 cm        | 2.5 cm   | 52            | 4                 |
| 18-24 mnd | 27 cm        | 2.5 cm   | 54            | 4                 |

**Check:** count your stitches after casting on. They should match the number in the "Cast-on (sts)" column for your size, before you work the garter stitch band and move on to part 2.



## PART 2: THE FLARE INCREASE

Switch to stockinette stitch. On the first row after the garter stitch band, increase evenly spaced across the whole row, using M1, so the collar flares outward from the neck edge. The number of increases and their spacing are calculated for every size, see the table below.

| Size      | Sts at cast-on | Number of M1 increases | Sts after increase row |
|-----------|----------------|------------------------|------------------------|
| 0-1 mnd   | 40             | 10                     | 50                     |
| 1-3 mnd   | 42             | 10                     | 52                     |
| 3-6 mnd   | 46             | 12                     | 58                     |
| 6-9 mnd   | 48             | 12                     | 60                     |
| 9-12 mnd  | 50             | 12                     | 62                     |
| 12-18 mnd | 52             | 14                     | 66                     |
| 18-24 mnd | 54             | 14                     | 68                     |

The increase row is worked so the plain stitches and the increases together use exactly the stitches you cast on in part 1, no extra stitches are knitted at the end. For 0-1 months: [k4, M1] repeated 10 times. After this one row you have 50 stitches, see the table for your own size.

**Then work 3 rows of stockinette stitch straight, with no further increasing or decreasing, before moving on to the lace border in part 3.**

## PART 3: THE LACE BORDER

Now the eyelet pattern itself is worked, a simple 2-row repeat that gives the lacy look, and the collar finishes with a picot bind-off along the whole outer edge.

Eyelet pattern (repeated 3 times = 6 rows in total): Row 1 (RS): \*yo, k2tog\* repeat to the end of the row.  
Row 2 (WS): purl all stitches. Because every yarn over adds one stitch and every k2tog removes one stitch, the stitch count stays exactly the same throughout the eyelet pattern.

Picot bind-off: bind off 2 sts knitwise. \*Bring the yarn forward between the needles, cast on 2 new stitches using a twisted (cable) cast-on, then bind off 4 sts (the 2 new stitches + the next 2 on the needle).\* Repeat from \* until the remaining stitches from the table below are left, bind these off plainly, with no picot, right to the end.

| Size      | Sts at lace border | Picot repeats | Remainder, bound off plain | Finished circumference |
|-----------|--------------------|---------------|----------------------------|------------------------|
| 0-1 mnd   | 50                 | 12            | 2                          | 22.7 cm                |
| 1-3 mnd   | 52                 | 13            | 0                          | 23.6 cm                |
| 3-6 mnd   | 58                 | 14            | 2                          | 26.4 cm                |
| 6-9 mnd   | 60                 | 15            | 0                          | 27.3 cm                |
| 9-12 mnd  | 62                 | 15            | 2                          | 28.2 cm                |
| 12-18 mnd | 66                 | 16            | 2                          | 30.0 cm                |
| 18-24 mnd | 68                 | 17            | 0                          | 30.9 cm                |

## BACK CLOSURE

The two short ends of the collar (the row ends on each side of the flat piece, where you started and finished each row) meet at the back and close with one button and one loop.

- 1 Crochet a chain of approx. 12-15 chain stitches with a 3 mm crochet hook, enough for the wooden button to pass through without stretching the loop.
- 2 Fasten the chain securely to one back edge of the collar, with a tapestry needle and a few extra stitches through the knitted fabric, so the loop stays firmly attached.
- 3 Sew a small wooden button onto the other back edge, directly opposite the loop, with double thread and several stitches through each hole in the button.
- 4 Test the closure: the button should slide easily through the loop, but not fall out on its own when the collar hangs freely.

## FINISHING

- 1 Weave in all loose ends securely on the wrong side, and trim them short.
- 2 Sew on the wooden button and fasten the chain loop at the back, see the previous page.
- 3 Lightly steam-block the collar on the wrong side, avoid pressing directly on the picot edge, it should keep its shape.
- 4 Lay the collar over the shoulders of the body, close the button at the back, and check that the neck edge sits evenly all the way round.
- 5 Finally, check that the button is securely attached, and that no loose threads or stitches can come undone.

## SAFETY AND CARE

### SAFETY

- Always use one small, securely attached button, and sew it on with double thread, several times through each hole.
- Check the button and the chain loop regularly, especially after washing, and reattach them at the first sign of looseness.
- This pattern is not intended for children who put small objects in their mouth unsupervised, never leave a baby alone and unsupervised in the collar during the first while of wearing it.
- The collar is a loose-fitting accessory, not part of the body itself, always follow current safety recommendations for children's clothing and make sure the collar cannot tighten around the neck.

### CARE INSTRUCTIONS

**Hand wash gently in lukewarm water with wool wash, or machine wash on a wool cycle at 30 degrees. Press out the water, gently ease the picot edge into shape, and dry lying flat on a towel. Avoid hanging the collar up to dry, alpaca can stretch out of shape.**

## ALL DONE!

**Congratulations, your lace collar is finished! It is made to be worn over the Woodland Dreams basisbody, and is the first of six accessory pieces in the collection.**

### THE REST OF THE COLLECTION

- The basisbody, the foundation of the collection, a top-down raglan body in stockinette stitch.
- Ruffle collar, the same fastening at the back, a little more romantic.
- Peter Pan collar, a classic rounded collar.
- Bib, tied with an i-cord or a button.
- I-cord suspenders, the collection's signature piece, adjustable and crossing at the back.
- Short vest, with wooden buttons at the front, worn over the body.
- Woodland Fluffy Skirt, a crocheted skirt made to match the body.

### COPYRIGHT

(c) Renate Dahl, Little Montessori Explorers. This pattern is a fully original LME design. You are welcome to sell finished garments you make from this pattern, on a small personal scale, provided the finished product is checked against current safety requirements. The pattern itself, its text and images, may not be shared, copied or resold.

By Renate Dahl · Little Montessori Explorers · [lmexplorers.com](https://lmexplorers.com)